

while on the move. However, this does not come across as uninterrupted, since there are two separate 5-hour rated batteries provided with the notebook. The test for a single battery charged to the maximum gave us a result of 3 hours and 43 minutes, which is excellent. Another great thing about this laptop is the 15.1 XGA Active Matrix screen with the ATI Mobility Radeon graphics card supporting a maximum resolution of 1400x1050. For those who enjoy an odd gaming session, this notebook is a proper delight with *Quake III* performing excellently at scores of 105 fps in normal settings.

Configured with a P-III 1.2 GHz mobile processor, 256 MB RAM, 30 GB of hard disk space, 8x DVD and all the standard features and connectors, this laptop is a perfect desktop replacement besides tough a mobile workhorse. But with a weight of 3.5 kg, it is a little bulky. Another mentionable feature is the availability of a Sony memory stick slot



along with Panasonic SD Memory card, which can be very useful if you use a digital camera or MP3 player. As far as benchmarking goes, it generated an index of 36 in Content Creation 2001 and 32.7 in Business Winstone 2001. Overall, users looking for a feature-rich desktop replacement with very less mobility would prefer this.

Rating: B+
Verdict: *Xtreme is a great desktop replacement in the truest sense.*

Zenith One Up- 21A

This brand came in armed with a band of goodies and freebies—an external USB TV Tuner with remote, Vehicle Power Adapter (for charging laptops while on the move in a vehicle), CD for relevant drivers, Windows 98SE and an Internet

Making a Choice			
You need	General A lightweight model but don't want to sacrifice screen and keyboard size	Desktop replacement Something that gives you all the functionality of your existing desktop PC	Ultra-portable A bit more panache, an ultra-light notebook might hit the sweet spot
Look for	A model that has an extra bay that would hold a CD/DVD-ROM, floppy drive, add-on battery, or even a CD-RW drive. These will generally offer a 13/14-inch XGA display and weigh less than 3 kg	Something that weighs about 4 kg and has a 15-inch (1280x1024) display. Most peripherals are within the laptop's chassis itself. A graphics adapter with 16 MB or more VRAM and a DVD-ROM drive.	You need a notebook lighter than 2 kg and, therefore, will have to suffer cramped keyboard, smaller (lower) resolutions. You will have limited connectivity options
The models	Zenith 21A, Sharp AR-50	Compaq Presario 1725, ACI Xtreme	Sharp Muramasu PC UM10
Price range	Rs 75,000-1,00,000	Up to Rs 1,75,000	Rs 1,00,000-1,50,000



starter pack with 25 hours of free surfing time. This laptop was configured with a P-III 850 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, and a 20 GB hard disk. A floppy drive and an 8x CD-Writer make the notebook a perfect portable companion. It has a 14.1-inch XGA TFT display and the battery supports a lifespan of almost one-and-a-half hours (1:35 mts).

This laptop was fully configured and came pre-installed with Windows 98SE. At one point we noticed here was that the battery not getting fully charged. We spoke to Zenith and the laptop was replaced with a perfectly working battery within a short span of time (approx 2 hours). That's service, one might say!

In the tests, Content Creation generated an index of 28.7, which could be mentioned at quite par, as the average score for this configuration machine hovers around an index of 30. A decent machine, nevertheless, for its price.

Rating: B
Verdict: *Packed to the hilt with any external peripheral you can dream of.*

Sharp Muramasa – PC UM10

This laptop from Sharp is one of the

sleekest notebooks we've received, literally. It has a thickness of only 16 mm and sports a bright silver color. It sports a brushed aluminium casing and the design looks clean and elegant.

The floppy drive as well as the CD-ROM drive bundled along have a special USB interface and can be plugged into the laptop using just one USB port, so you would have to keep shuttling either of the drives.

Another noteworthy feature in this notebook is the high-resolution Active Matrix display which allows you to view the screen from an angle of 90 degrees. Bundled along are applications like Windows Me, MS Money, Internet Starter Kit, and so on. Configuration with a P-III



600 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, and 20 GB Hard disk, this machine definitely cannot be pitted against P-III 1 GHz warriors, but with its stunning looks and stylish features, it comes out on top as far as portability goes.

Rating: B+
Verdict: *Cute-looking laptop that comes with a crisp TFT.*

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